Addis Ababa University

ADDIS ABABA UNIVERSITY ANTI-PLAGIARISM POLICY FRAMEWORK, 2019

Addis Ababa

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1. Introduction

Addis Ababa University is the largest and the oldest University in Ethiopia. Over the past 70 year's span of time since its formation, the contribution it made to the academic world is indeed immense. As a witness to fascinating advances in research, teaching and community services it made, it has received spectacular recognitions from the international community both in terms of wining commendable rankings and expanding high-level university partnerships overseas. Holding integrity and honesty; academic freedom; excellence; reliance on evidence and authority of reason as its core values, the university has graduated several batches of graduates and contributed its share to the civil service development of the nation.

Despite this success however the university has not yet had its own plagiarism policy. The university's great achievement will not continue unless the quality of education and research work maintains its scientific standard and academic integrity. Plagiarism policy is critical in order to ensure the rights of authorship and quality of academic endeavors. The university needs to have an anti- plagiarism policy framework in order to control all forms of plagiarism offenses and thereby ensure academic quality in all its programs of studies.

One of the means of achieving academic integrity and improving quality of education and research at AAU is introducing an anti- plagiarism policy in the university that will introduce lawful educational activities and research works. The university has already confirmed the vitality of academic integrity for academic excellence that is free from all forms academic offense and plagiarism in many of the articles it stipulated.

2. Purpose

This policy document frames up guidelines and frameworks that would help Addis Ababa University manage academic theft or plagiarism offenses in the university. It spells out the principle of AAU towards plagiarism, the process AAU applies when plagiarism is detected and confirmed, and the responses of the University to plagiarism offenses. The policy framework has been developed in strict compliance with the Addis Ababa Senate Legislation (2018).

The policy aspires to put in place in AAU a quality academic culture that does not tolerate academic misconducts such as plagiarism, examination cheating and offenses directly or indirectly related to these. It ensures the wellbeing of academic practices in the university by providing complete protection to the originality of creativities and inventions made by the

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university community. Moreover, the policy framework creates awareness about plagiarism among the community and informs the same as how to avoid it.

It provides consistent procedure on how to handle case of plagiarism in the University. The policy maintains and reinforces the core values of AAU and its academic integrity.

3. Scope

The policy framework applies to all staff (academic, research and support staff) and students of Addis Ababa university (undergraduate, graduate, extension, distance) tuition-paying and non-tuition paying formally registered and learning in the University. This policy covers all forms of plagiarism offenses committed by the members of the academic and research community indicated above across all campuses and programs of the university and across all academic and research units such as colleges, institutes, departments, and centers.

4. Definitions

Plagiarism is the presentation of someone else's work, words, images, ideas, opinions, discoveries, artwork, music, recordings or computer-generated work (including circuitry, computer programs or software, websites, the Internet or other electronic resources) whether published or not, as one's own work, or alternatively appropriating the work, words, images, ideas, opinions, discoveries, artwork, music, recordings or computer-generated work (including circuitry, computer programs or software, websites, the Internet or other electronic resource) of others, without properly acknowledging the source, with or without the source's permission.

In brief, plagiarism is the use of ideas or material of others without acknowledgement, or the re-use of one's own previously evaluated or published material without acknowledgement (self-plagiarism). Plagiarism may be intentional or reckless, or unintentional but all are academic disciplinary offence. It may take various forms such as excessive aggregation, rewording a source, remix, and hybrid forms of plagiarism.

5. Policy statement

This policy framework comprises the following principles, prohibitions, conditions and measures

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5.1 Principles and prohibitions

1. It is an established academic and higher education convention that copying or stealing someone else's work as if it were one's own work or brain child without making clear acknowledgements to the legitimate owner of the material or work is forbidden or unacceptable. Addis Ababa University complies strictly with this academic tradition.
2. Any academic or scholarly or scientific or research or art work or text or material taken from the original material or source material in all academic exercises of Addis Ababa university must be separated or delineated from the work of the copier and distinctively marked. The original source must be cited or properly quoted and duly credited using all known documentation conventions to date, and conventions that are appropriate to the respective fields of studies or disciplines.
3. All academic staff, researchers, students ,and academics must learn and apply the knowledge for paraphrasing original materials, quoting from them where necessary properly and acknowledging source materials as scientific as possible and failure to do so will expose subjects to the clear offence of plagiarism.
4. All colleges, research institutes, academic units, departments and centers must implement the stipulations set in this policy framework and report to the concerned university authority the actions they take on any one who attempts plagiarism as per the articles of this policy.
5. Depending on their own contexts, academic units or departments may have even stricter measures than those set out in this document in order to ensure academic quality and academic integrity and professionalism. The measures set in this generic policy will however be strictly observed as minimum standards to be taken to mitigate the offences of plagiarism.
6. Any form of work may be tolerated up to a maximum of 20% incidental plagiarism (green color) from any original work (but even this 20%, if it is at a stretch, continuous or uninterrupted copying of someone else's work, it may be taken as plagiarism). In a research work in progress such as a PhD thesis, upon 25% plagiarism in any piece of work, a convict will be given a preliminary oral warning (yellow color) and upon 35% plagiarism, a convict/plagiarist will be given a serious warning in writing (orange color), and upon 45% plagiarism (red color), a plagiarist will automatically be liable for legal measures or fines as per the appropriate legal codes of the country.
7. AAU shall introduce software for detecting and measuring plagiarism offenses in all programs it runs across the university. AAU trains all staff on how to use the plagiarism

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software and the staff can use the software to check students' term papers, thesis, dissertation and articles to be submitted for publications. However, coordinators shall always check and report to the department before thesis defense. Plagiarism software report will be checked by thesis advisers before a thesis, research paper or a project work is accepted for formal considerations.

8. Full compliance to the terms of this policy framework is mandatory by all members of the University community. Any one trespassing/breach of this policy shall be held as an offensive and thereof shall face penalties that the offense entails as per relevant legal codes of the country.

5.2 Anti-plagiarism measures or actions to be taken

Anyone who attempts any form of plagiarism in Addis Ababa University is deemed to face any one or many of the following measures (depending on the severity of the plagiarism committed):

- Corrective measures in the form of advice or warning (see color ranges above)
- Deduction of marks
- Expulsion of the offender from a course or program tentatively and/or permanently
- Disqualification or cancellation of one's work where plagiarism is attempted
- Rejection or termination of scholarships, grants or similar opportunities
- Defamation or loss of reputation of the perpetrator on university/campus and public media outlets
- Loss of job or termination of job contracts, promotions
- Revoke the university degree earned via plagiarism
- Revoke academic titles

In addition to these measures however, the culprit may be penalized for crime against the relevant laws of the country.

5.3 Conditions to be met for plagiarism to occur

For any piece of academic or scientific or artistic work to be considered as a plagiarized one, the following requirements have to be fully met;

- The work is a partial or a complete copy of the source or original material

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- The copied material may be an idea, ideas or texts, figures, facts, tables, and direct expressions without any acknowledgement and proper citation of the source material or author
- There is an indication or a sign where the perpetrator directly or indirectly claims that the work copied or plagiarized is his /her own work
- The original ideas or texts are deliberately mixed up (there is no separation or delineation) in an attempt to give readers an impression that the ideas or texts of the source are the ideas or texts of the perpetrator.
- The source of the copied or plagiarized material could be any one of the following and related materials: books, book chapters, papers submitted for course assignments in universities or similar institutions, research articles (published or unpublished), materials in print, journal articles, conference proceedings, PhD/ MSc/MA thesis work or chapters from the thesis, webpages, examination scripts, booklets, software, models, designs, on-line teaching materials, art works, plans, maps, blue-prints, etc.

6. Responsibilities

The following will be responsible in the management of the plagiarism policy of AAU:

- Any concerned staff member, a student, or someone from outside the university whose work he/she feels has been plagiarized/or at least has been threatened by an act of plagiarism/ may initiate a legal relief by applying /reporting the case to the academic unit where the offence of the plagiarism is presumed to have occurred or happened.
- Depending on the magnitude (scale) of plagiarism, the department may take an appropriate legal action as per this policy framework (if the case is a minor one) or reports the case to the College or institute level academic commission, for the necessary legal measure. If the case is beyond the scope of the department, the case shall be forwarded to College Level Anti-Plagiarism Committee. The committees check the case and examine the allegation within a month and report the findings to the academic commission. If the case still appears to be beyond the scope the college, the concerned college may report the case to the AVP of the University for Further Action. If the magnitude of plagiarism is High Scale, university hearing will be made by the senate executive committee and senate.

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- If the University, College, Research Institute, School/Department or center discovered that a former student committed plagiarism or other types of academic fraud to earn that degree, it can be revoked by the decision of the senate.
- Supervisors are required to sit with their students and run the thesis, research paper, or project report through plagiarism software in order to provide guidance on any revisions that may be required as a result of this process,. Supervisors must then sign relevant forms indicating that the student has indeed run their work through plagiarism detection software.

7. Records management

All academic committees of all academic units in the university and the University Registrar shall have the responsibility of keeping records of all plagiarism cases, investigations and measures taken and must report any time if they are required to do so. All confirmed cases of student plagiarism will be stored at AAU Registrar Office and students' records will be updated accordingly. The record will help to determine the appropriate penalty based on the Penalty Scale.

8. Related legislation and documents

Any article or statement of this policy framework that goes in contrary with the statements stipulated in AAU's current legislation shall not be applicable.

9. Implementation guidelines

A separate detailed guideline of implementation will accompany this policy framework. The guidelines will facilitate the implementation of all articles in this framework.

10. Feedback

The university community members may forward comments and feed back to this policy framework by directly contacting the office of the President.

11. Approval and review details (version control)

Approval and review	Details
Name of document as intended to be cited where needed	Addis Ababa University Anti-Plagiarism Policy Framework, 2019
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End.

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